Sergei Kudriashov

Shenzhen, China
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Education

Chinese University of Hong Kong, Shenzhen From Oct. 2026
PhD in artificial intelligence, supervised by Prof. Zhi-Quan (Tom) Luo

Higher School of Economics, Moscow Sep. 2025 — Aug. 2026
PhD in artificial intelligence, supervised by Prof. Maxim Rakhuba, withdrew after the first year

Higher School of Economics, Moscow Sep 2023 — June 2025
M.S. Computational Linguistics & Math | Top 1% of the program

Higher School of Economics, Moscow Sep 2019 — June 2023
B.S. Theoretical & Applied Linguistics with a major in Neurolinguistics

Leadership and service

Monoid AI Safety Hub | *Seminar lecturer & mentor on "Evals for AI Safety" course* Mar. 2026 – Jul. 2026
Volunteered teaching and mentorship for the course for 150+ participants across Russia and the CIS.
Mentees submitted a paper to *EACL 2027*.

Faculty of Computer Science, HSE | *Seminar lecturer in "Matrix computations"* Jan. 2026 – May 2026
Taught seminars for undergraduate students from the CS department.
Helped with course organization and exam assessment within the lab.

School of Linguistics, HSE | *Co-supervisor for Master's theses in AI safety* Jan. 2026 – May 2026
Supervised two Master's theses on technical approaches for safe LLM training and evaluations.
Both defended with "excellent" grades.

Work and Research Experience

MARS V Research Fellowship, Cambridge AI Safety Hub | *Researcher* Jul. 2026 – Oct. 2026
Studying how language models' behaviour shifts under changes in tokenization that leave the text unchanged.
Supervised by Dmitry Vaintrob. Selected at less than 5% acceptance rate.

Matrix and Tensor methods in Machine Learning Lab, HSE | *Researcher* Mar. 2025 – Aug. 2026

Model risk department, Sberbank | *Data scientist* Jul. 2024 – Feb. 2026
Evaluated and assessed the whole LLM development pipeline: pretraining, instruction tuning and post-training
Suggested changes that increased the performance on downstream benchmarks up to 30%
Performed evals for open-source and closed-source LLMs
Wrote internal reports on methodology and comparison with competitors across metrics & modeling approaches

Laboratory of Linguistic Conflictology, HSE | *Research Assistant* Sep. 2022 – Winter 2024
Collected and analyzed a corpus of conflict development and mitigation strategies in online communities.

Laboratory of Linguistic Convergence, HSE | *Research Assistant* Sep. 2020 – Spring 2023
Documented endangered languages (Itelmen, Adyghe, Kildin Sami) in the laboratory and field trips.

Selected publications

Pay Attention to Attention Distribution: A New Local Lipschitz Bound for Transformers |
Second author | *ECCV 2026* 2026

Tensorion: A Tensor-Aware Generalization of the Muon Optimizer |
Co-author, Theory and experimental design | *ICML 2026, Workshop Spotlight* 2026

FiMMIA: scaling semantic perturbation-based membership inference across modalities |
Co-first author | *EACL 2026* 2026

Why You Need Polar Decomposition: Fast Differentiable SVD on GPU |
Co-author, Theory | *Submitted to NeurIPS 2026* 2026

Shrink the longest: improving latent space isotropy with symplicial geometry |
First author | *AIST, LNCS, Springer* 2024

Selected Projects and Awards

AI Safety Connections | *Research and Educational Project* Winter 2026
A gamification of AI Safety principles. Started as a project for *Monoid LLM Steering Hackathon*. Was used by 150+ participants to make learning more accessible and simplify an transition to the field.

Apart Research – submission for Secret Loyalties Hackathon | **1st place winner** Aug. 2026
Black-box loyalty identification as statistical inference: An Audit of Secretly-Loyal Model Organisms

SMILES-2024, Summer School in Machine Learning | **1st place winner** Aug. 2024
Award for the project: "Extreme optimal transport for voice conversion"

Additional Education

Iliad Intensive | *Iliad, London, UK* Sep. 2026
Course in emerging approaches in technical and mathematical AI safety.
Admitted at less than 5% acceptance rate among PhD graduates and postdocs.

Technical AI Safety | *BlueDot Impact, online* Spring 2026

2nd Conference-School On Tensor Methods in Math and AI | *Shenzhen MSU-BIT University* Oct. 2025

TFML | *Summer School in Theoretical machine learning, Genova* Jun. 2025

Virtual-NYI-3 | *Summer School in Linguistics, Cognitive and Cultural Studies* Jul. 2021

Languages

English | *C1 – fluent*

Finnish | *B2 – mostly reading*

Public Talks

Probing and neighborhood: explanation of language models |
Workshop, Concort-2024, Moscow